

Mouth Ulcers - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1216 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Mouth ulcer assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Child patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant or immunocompromised, how long has the lesion been present, and is there fever, dehydration, weight loss, trauma, tobacco/betel use, medicine exposure, eye/genital lesions, or safeguarding concern?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] How large is it, and is it painful?
3. [YES_NO] Any ulcers elsewhere on the body or joint pain?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Disposition level 50

Are fluid-filled blisters on or around the lips the main concern rather than ulcers inside the mouth?

The cold-sore family is not generated. Arrange in-person clinical assessment through the Qatar route approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED).

1. Disposition level 50

Has the ulcer lasted longer than 3 weeks, is it unusually large or near the throat, is it bleeding or becoming more painful and red, or are there ulcers elsewhere on the body with joint symptoms?

NHS.UK guidance recommends arranging clinical review through a Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) or dentist for these features - prolonged ulcers can occasionally indicate a more serious condition.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a typical, recent mouth ulcer with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance: mouth ulcers are common and should clear up on their own within 1-2 weeks.

Advice

Routine mouth ulcer follow-up

- Book a clinical or dental review through a Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) for these features.
- Call Back If: ulcer grows or bleeds more.

Governed care for a minor mouth ulcer

- Use a soft toothbrush, cool soft foods/fluids if swallowing safely, and avoid irritating spicy, salty, acidic, or rough foods. Mouthwash, analgesic gel/spray, steroid lozenge, and salt-rinse advice require exact age, pregnancy/breastfeeding, allergy, swallowing safety, medical conditions, and current-medicine checks under the approved Qatar pathway. Do not apply aspirin to the ulcer.
- Call Back If: lasts longer than 3 weeks; becomes larger, more painful, recurrent, or associated with fever, dehydration, weight loss, eye/genital lesions, or immunocompromise.

First aid

References

- NHS.UK, "Mouth ulcers", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/mouth-ulcers/> (page last reviewed 11 March 2024)

Provenance

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